Check-In Guide

Planning Center Check-Ins

For Bus Route & Sunday School Volunteers

This guide walks you through how to record attendance from your phone using a Roster Station.

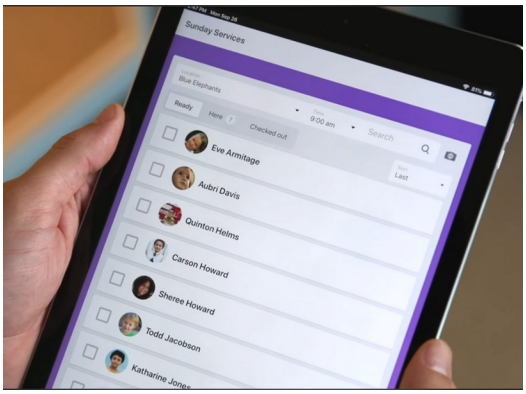
Please note that if you are taking attendance through Check-Ins, you **no longer have to take attendance through Groups**. This will be the new way to

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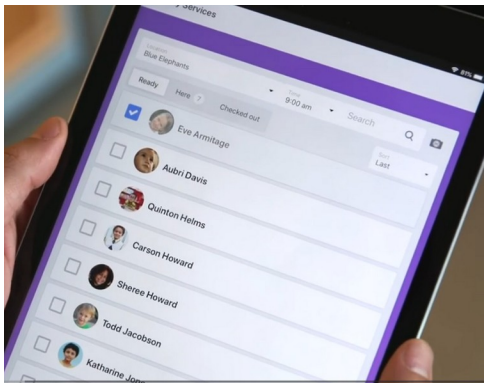
Part 1 — Check In Someone on Your List

If the person already appears on your roster, the process is quick and straightforward:

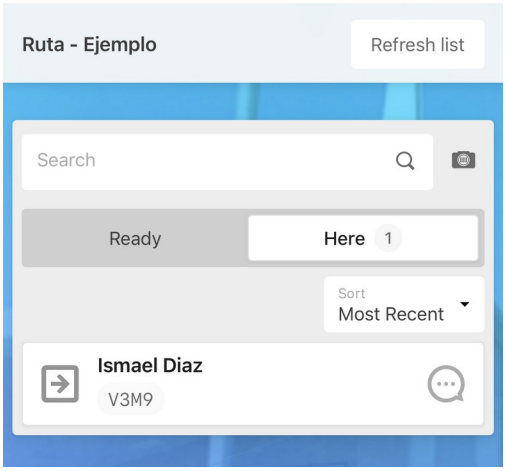
1. Open the Check-Ins app on your phone. You'll see the list of people assigned to your group.



2. Find the person's name and tap it to select them. A checkmark ( ) will appear next to their name.



3. Wait about two seconds. The person will move from the **"Ready"** column to the **"Here"** column, confirming the check-in was successful.



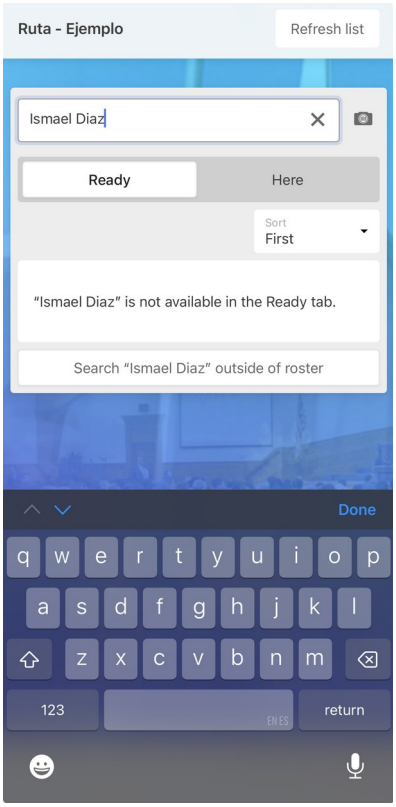
That's it! Once the person appears in the "Here" column, their check-in is complete.

Can't find the person on your list? Continue to Part 2.

Part 2 — Check In Someone Not on Your List

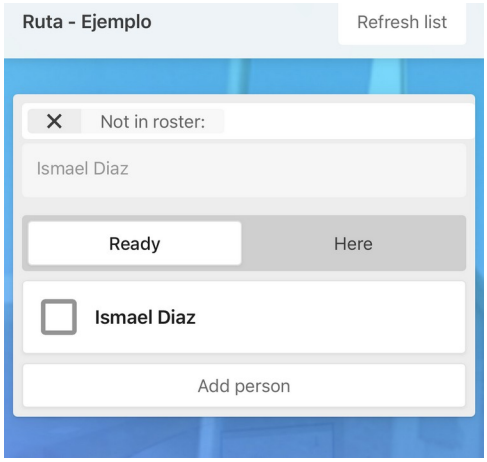
If a person is visiting your route or class and doesn't appear on your roster, you can search for them in the church's full system.

1. Tap the **"Search"** bar and type the person's full name.

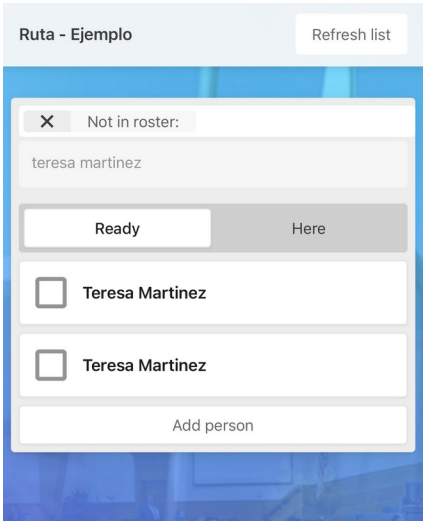


2. If the person is on the roster, they'll show up in the results. If not, tap **"Search [name] outside of roster"** to search the entire church system.

3. If the person exists in the system, their name will appear in the results. Tap it to add them to check-in. Wait two seconds and they'll move to the **"Here"** column.



Duplicate names: Sometimes two people share the same name and there's no way to tell them apart in the app. The image below shows an example of this. If this happens, write down the name and head to the printer room — talk to Hna. Lira and she'll help you sort it out from the computer there.



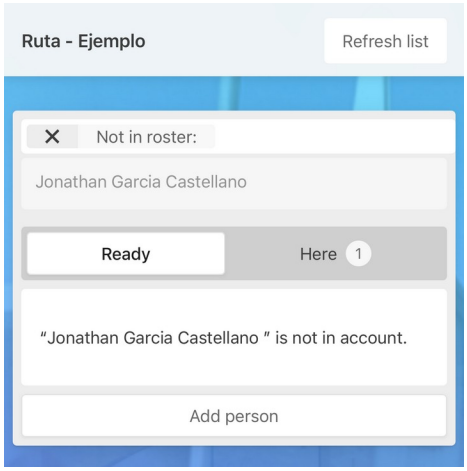
Person doesn't show up in any search results? They may be brand new to the system (i.e. a visitor). Continue to Part 3.

Part 3 — Register a Brand New Visitor

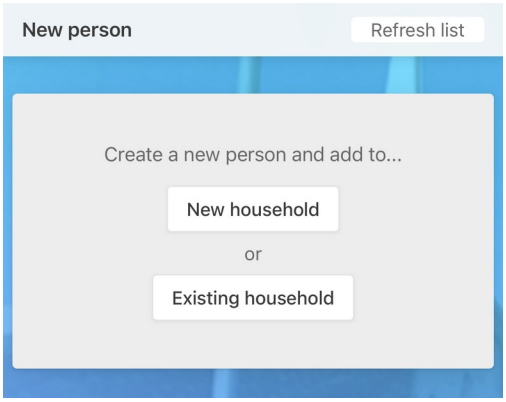
If the person has never been registered in the church system, you'll need to create a new record for them. First, one important concept:

> **What is a "Household"?**
>
> A **household** is the family group a person is registered under in Planning Center. When adding someone new, you'll need to indicate whether they belong to a completely new family or to a family that already exists in the system.

1. Follow steps 1 and 2 from Part 2. If the person doesn't appear in any results, tap **"Add person"**.



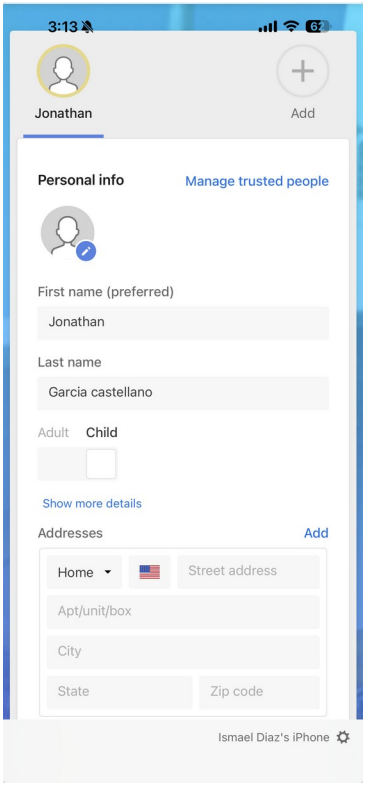
2. You'll see two options: **"New Household"** and **"Existing Household"**.

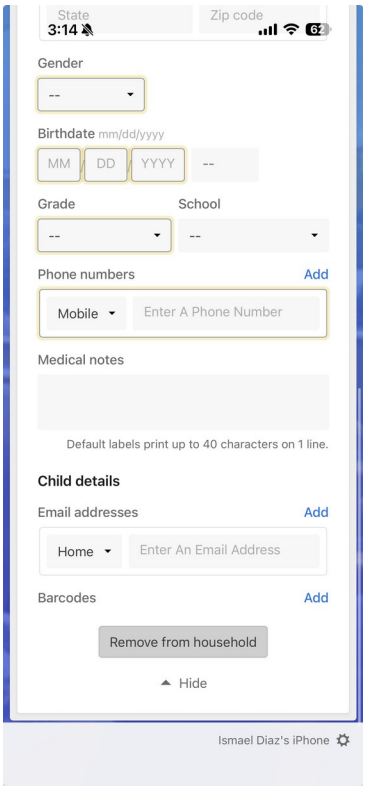


Option A — New Household (Brand new family)

Select **"New Household"** if the person and their family have never attended the church before.

3. Fill in the form with the person's first name, last name, and any other required fields.
4. Once you've filled in their information, tap **"Add Household"** to save.
5. Now go back and search for the person using the regular search method from Part 2 and check them in from there.

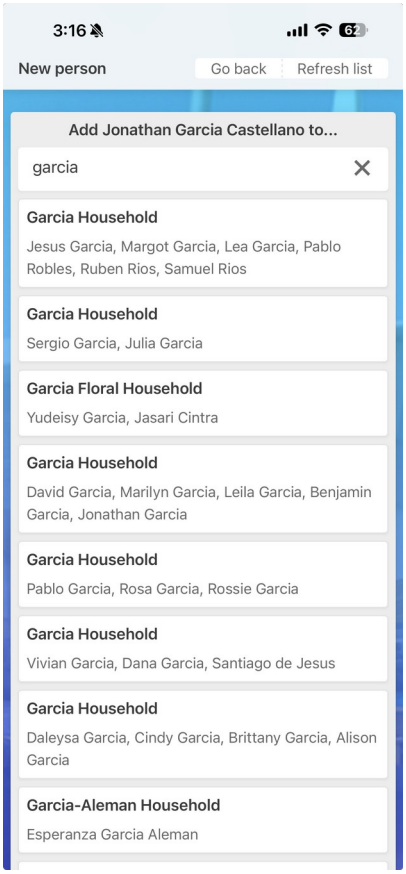




Option B — Existing Household (Family already in the system)

Select **"Existing Household"** if other family members are already in the system and only this specific person is new.

1. Type the family's last name in the search bar and select the correct household from the list.
2. Fill in the new person's information and tap **"Save"** to add them to the household.
3. Now go back and search for the person using the regular search method from Part 2 and check them in from there.



Always enter the name correctly. This keeps your data clean and makes it easier to recognize this person on future visits.

Quick Reference

Situation	What to Do
Person is on my roster	Tap their name → Wait → Confirm they moved to "Here" (Part 1)
Not on my list, but in the system	Search ( ) → Tap name → Confirm check-in (Part 2)
Brand new visitor	Search → Add person → New or Existing Household → Fill info → Go

	back and check in via Part 2 (Part 3)

Thank you for serving!

If you have any questions, reach out to your area coordinator.